

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Problem Statement:

The current IT procurement process lacks efficiency and automation, resulting in delays and manual overhead, particularly in handling standard laptop orders. Requests for standard laptops often require configuration, but this step is prone to oversight or delay, leading to frustration among users and inefficient resource allocation within the IT department.

User Story:

As a member of the IT procurement team, I want a streamlined process for ordering standard laptops so that tasks are automatically generated and assigned to the hardware team for configuration. This will ensure that laptops are promptly configured upon arrival, reducing user wait times and minimising manual intervention.

Project Objective:

The objective of this project is to implement an automated workflow using Flow Designer to facilitate the procurement and configuration of standard laptops. By integrating automation into the process, the project aims to:

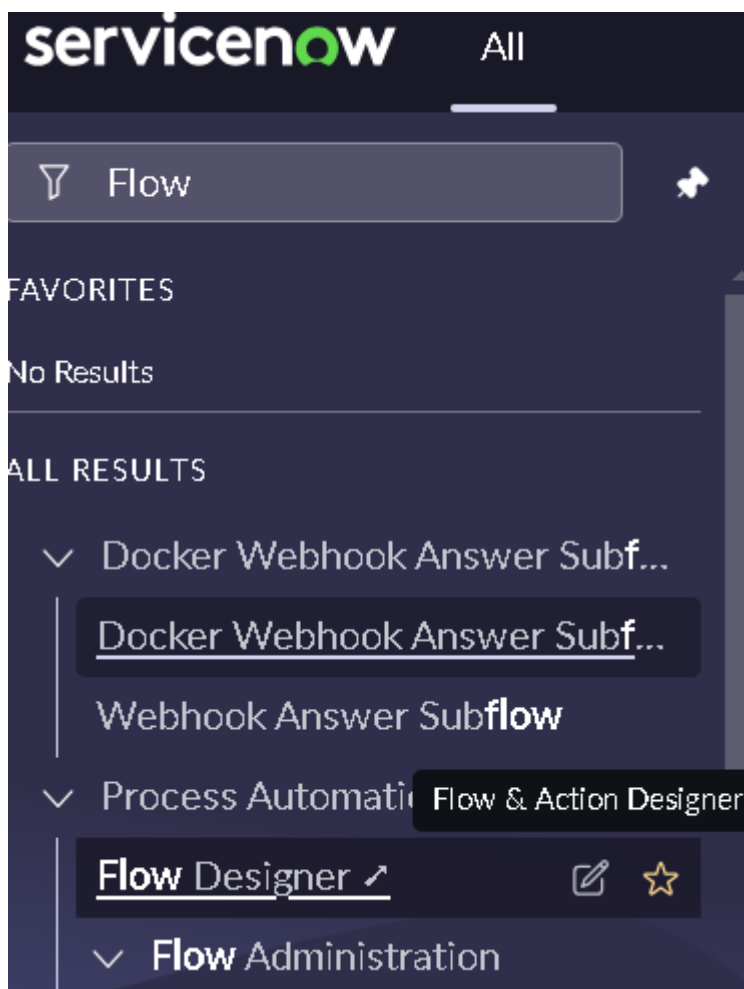
1. Create a seamless experience for users requesting standard laptops by ensuring timely configuration.
2. Reduce manual intervention and potential errors in the procurement process.
3. Improve resource utilisation within the IT department by optimising task allocation.
4. Enhance overall efficiency and productivity in IT procurement operations.

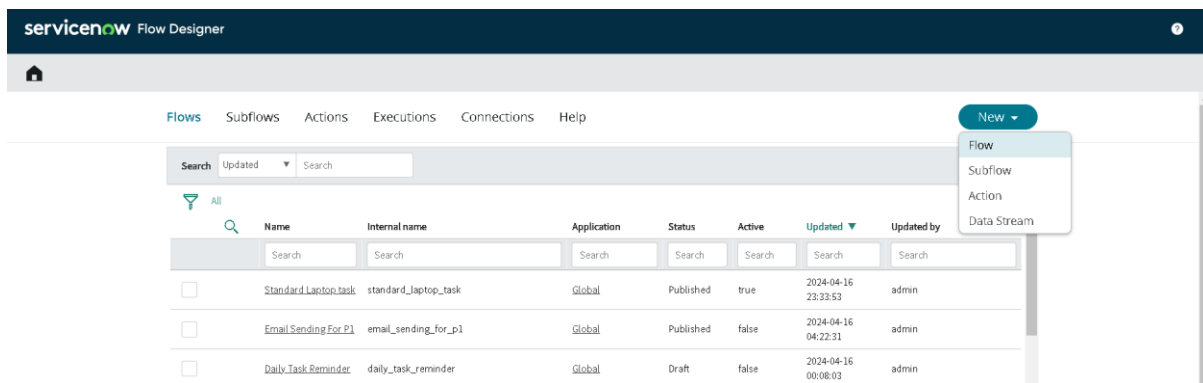
TASK INITIATION

Milestone 1 : Flow

Activity 1: Create a Flow to Create Catalog task to update the short description after Approval the service Request and it will be Assignment group to Hardware.

1. Open service now.
2. Click on All >> search for Flow Designer
3. Click on Flow Designer under Process Automation.
4. After opening Flow Designer Click on new and select Flow.
5. Under Flow properties Give Flow Name as “ Standard laptop task”.
6. Application should be Global.
7. Select Run user as “ System user ” from that choice.
8. Click on Submit.





Flow properties

* Flow name: Standard Laptop task

Description: Describe your flow

Application: Global

Protection: -- None --

Run As: System User

Cancel Submit

9. Click on Add a trigger
10. Select the trigger in that Search for “ Service Catalog ” and select that.
11. After that click on Done.

TRIGGER

✕ Abort trigger creation

Trigger

RECORD

- Created
- Updated
- Created or Updated

DATE

- Daily

Created

Trigger initiates from a ServiceNow record creation that meets the condition filter.

ACTIONS

+ Add an Action, Flow

ERROR HANDLER

TRIGGER

 Service Catalog + ✕

Trigger

12. Now under Actions.
13. Click on Add an action.
14. Select action in that search for “ Create Catalog Task ” and select that.
15. Mention these in that action
16. Action as Create Catalog Task
17. Drag and drop the Requested Item Record in the Request item.
18. Table will be auto populated as a Catalog Task.
19. Mention the short description as “ Laptop need to Configured ”.
20. Click on add field value
21. Select description field and value as “ Laptop need to Configured ”.

22. Select Assignment group field and value as “ Hardware ”.
23. Select Approval field and value as “ Approved ”.
24. Leave the remaining as default and click on Done.
25. Click on save the Flow.
26. And Click on Activate again click on Activate.



Standard Laptop task

Active

The screenshot displays the ServiceNow Flow Designer interface. At the top, there are three tabs: 'Action', 'Flow Logic', and 'Subflow'. The 'Action' tab is active. Below the tabs, there is a search bar labeled 'Search Actions'. A dropdown menu is open, showing a list of actions. The 'Create Catalog Task' action is highlighted at the top of the list. The list also includes 'Look Up Record', 'Wait For Condition', 'Create Record', 'SLA Percentage Timer', 'Send Email', 'Update Record', and 'Create Template ACL'. The 'Create Catalog Task' action is associated with 'ServiceNow Core'. The background shows a partial view of the 'ERROR HANDLING' section with the text 'If an error occurs'.

Standard Laptop task Active View: [icon] [icon] Test De

1 **now** Create Catalog Task ⓘ [icon] [icon] [icon] [icon]

Action ▼ Create Catalog Task

Table Name ▼ Catalog Task [sc_task] [icon]

* Requested Item [Requested Item] Trigger - ... ▶ Requested Item ... [icon] [icon]

Short Description ▼ Laptop needs to Configured [icon] [icon]

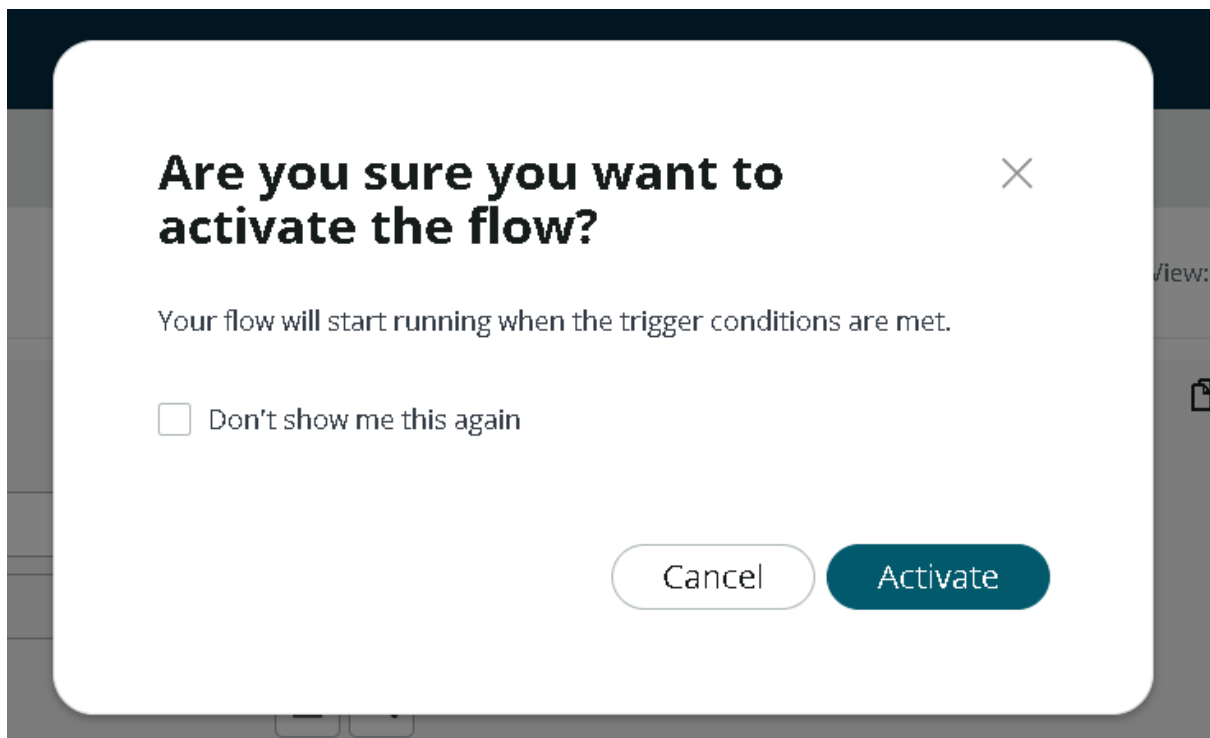
Fields

Description	×	Laptop needs to Configured	[icon] [icon] ⊖
Assignment group	×	Hardware	⊙ [icon] [icon] [icon] ⊖
Approval	×	Approved	[icon] [icon] [icon] ⊖

+ Add field value

Wait ☒ [icon] [icon]

Template Catalog ▼ Select Template Catalog Item [icon]



Milestone 2 : Flow assignment

Activity 1 : Flow Assignment to Standard laptop service Catalog.

1. Open ServiceNow.

2. Click on all search for Maintain Items.
3. Select Maintain Items.
4. Under the name field search for Standard Laptop Select that record.
5. Under that record select Process engine
6. Remove the remaining automations and add Flow.
7. Add the flow that was created with the name “ Standard Laptop Task”.
8. Click on the menu to save the record.

Name	Short description	Active	Roles	Catalogs	Category	Price	Type	Updated
Standard Laptop	Lenovo - Carbon x1	true		Service Catalog	Hardware	\$1,100.00	Item	2024-04-16 04:14:53
Standard 27" Monitor	Size - 27", Resolution - 1920x1080, ...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$0.00	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33
Standard 22" Monitor	Full HD, IPS Panel with VGA, HDMI, DVI, ...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$200.00	Item	2016-03-08 16:49:50
Standard 24" Monitor	TUV-certified Monitor Has Flicker-free S...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$292.28	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33

Catalog Item: Standard Laptop

Update Copy Try It Edit in Catalog Builder De

Name: Standard Laptop Application: Global ⓘ

Catalogs: Service Catalog ⓘ

Category: Hardware ⓘ

Active: ☒

Fulfillment automation level: Unspecified

State: -- None --

Checked out: -- None --

Owner: ⓘ

Item Details | Process Engine | Picture | Pricing | Portal Settings

Select the appropriate process engine for the catalog item. Only one engine can be selected.

Flow: Standard Laptop task ⓘ

Workflow: ⓘ

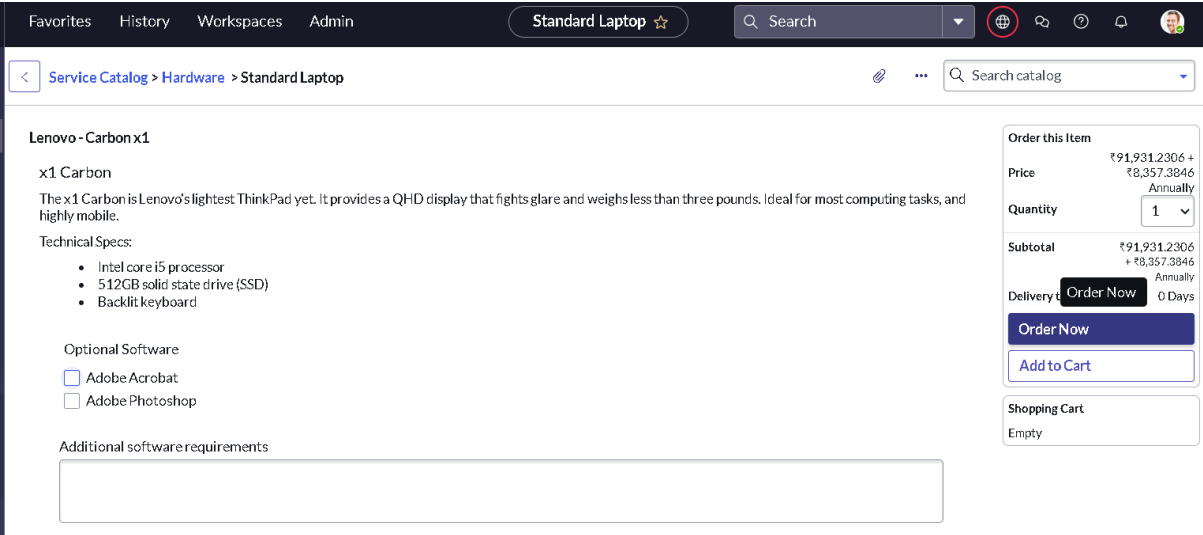
Execution Plan: ⓘ

Update Copy Try It Edit in Catalog Builder Delete

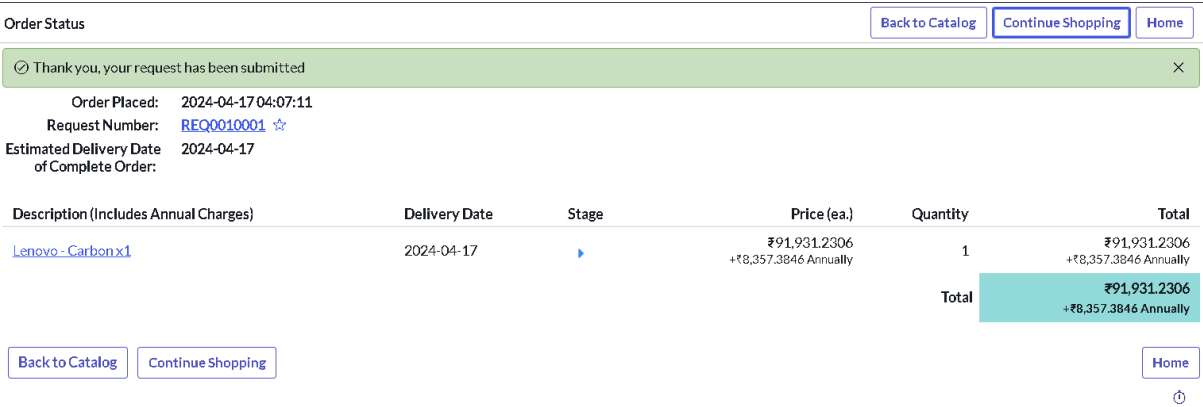
Milestone 3 : Service Catalog

Activity 1: Service Catalog for placing order and get Approval

- 1. Click on All >> Search for “ Service Catalog ”.
- 2. Click on Service Catalog >> click on Hardware.
- 3. Scroll a bit to find the “ Standard Laptop ” click on that.
- 4. After that click on “ Order Now ” to place the request.



- 5. Now we will see the Order status
- 6. In that click on the Request Number



7. It will open the Requested number record.
8. Scroll down Click on the Approvers Section.

Request - REQ0010001

Short description

Special instructions

Update Add New Item Cancel Request Copy Delete

Related Links

Show Workflow

Workflow Context

Requested Items (1) Approvers (1) Recurring Prices (1)

State Search

Approval for = REQ0010001

State	Approver	Comments	Created
Requested	Eric Schroeder		2024-04-17 04:07:12

1 to 1 of 1

9. Right Click on the Record to see config in that Click on the Approve.

Update Add New Item Cancel Request Copy Delete

Related Links

Show Workflow

Workflow Context

Requested Items (1) Approvers (1) Recurring Prices (1)

State Search

Approval for = REQ0010001

State	Approver	Comments	Created
Requested	Eric Schroeder		2024-04-17 04:07:12

1 to 1 of 1

10. Then click on the Requested item Section
11. Open that Requested Item record

[Favorites](#)
[History](#)
[Workspaces](#)
[Admin](#)
 Requested Item - RITM0010001

[Request Item RITM0010001](#)
[Discuss](#)
[Follow](#)
[Update](#)
[Delete](#)

Activities: 1

System Administrator

Impact 3 - Low
 Opened by System Administrator
 Priority 4 - Low
 State Open

 Field changes • 2024-04-17 04:07:10

[Update](#)
[Delete](#)

Related Links
[Flow Context](#)

[Catalog Tasks \(1\)](#)
[Approvers](#)
[Group approvals](#)

[Actions on selected rows...](#)
[New](#)

Request item = RITM0010001

Number	Assignment group	Assigned to	Short description	Actual start	Actual end	Order
SCTASK0010001	Hardware	(empty)	Laptop needs to Configured	2024-04-17 04:11:40	(empty)	

1 to 1 of 1

12. Scroll down to the “ Catalog tasks ” Section

13. Open the record to see the updated status of the record with Short description and Assigned group.

[Catalog Task SCTASK0010001](#)
[Discuss](#)
[Follow](#)
[Update](#)
[Close Task](#)
[Delete](#)

Number
 Approval

Assigned to
 Priority

Configuration item
 State

Active ☒
 Request item

Requested for

Short description

Description

Worknotes

[Post](#)

Activities: 1

Conclusion :

By automating the standard laptop procurement process with ServiceNow's Flow Designer, the project effectively addresses inefficiencies and reduces manual overhead. This streamlined workflow ensures timely configuration of laptops, minimizes

user wait times, and enhances overall productivity within the IT department. The implementation of this automated solution not only optimizes resource allocation but also significantly improves the user experience by providing a seamless and efficient procurement process.